

Beyond the Video — Syllabus Gaps for SSC CGL

Constitutional Acts (1773–1935), Socio-Religious Reform Movements, the Drain of Wealth theory, Press & Censorship laws, and post-1947 Princely State Integration

SSC CGL

SSC CHSL / CPO / MTS / GD

Railway NTPC

State Police

NDA

Why this PDF exists: Parts 1–8 covered everything in the source lecture in full detail. But several topics that appear regularly in actual SSC CGL papers were never touched by that lecture at all. This PDF fills exactly those gaps — verified against current reference sources and cross-checked against real SSC CGL previous-year questions — so your Modern History revision has no blind spots left.

1 Constitutional & Administrative Acts (1773–1935) 🔥

This is the single most tested "gap" topic — a continuous chain of Acts that gradually took India from Company rule to Crown rule to near-self-government. Learn it as one unbroken timeline.

Act	Key change
Regulating Act, 1773	First Parliamentary control over the East India Company; created the post of Governor-General of Bengal (first: Warren Hastings); set up a 4-member Executive Council and a Supreme Court at Calcutta (1774)
Pitt's India Act, 1784	Introduced " dual government " — the Company kept commerce/day-to-day administration, while a new Board of Control in London (6 members) oversaw political matters
Charter Act, 1793	Extended the Company's trade monopoly by 20 years; allowed Board of Control salaries to be paid from Indian revenue
Charter Act, 1813	Ended the Company's trade monopoly except in tea and trade with China ; allowed Christian missionaries into India; earmarked funds for Indian education
Charter Act, 1833	Ended all Company commercial activity — it became a purely administrative body; Governor-General of Bengal became Governor-General of India (first: Lord William Bentinck); added a Law Member (first: Macaulay) to the council
Charter Act, 1853	Separated legislative and executive functions of the council; introduced open competition for the civil services (opening them to Indians in theory); added provincial representation to the legislative council
Government of India Act, 1858	Transferred power from the Company to the British Crown after the 1857 revolt; ended the Board of Control/Court of Directors; Governor-General became "Viceroy" (first: Lord Canning); created the post of Secretary of State for India
Indian Councils Act, 1861	Restored limited legislative power to Bombay and Madras; began including Indian non-official members in the Viceroy's council
Indian Councils Act, 1892	Expanded legislative councils; introduced (limited, indirect) elections and allowed councils to discuss the budget
Indian Councils Act, 1909 (Morley-Minto Reforms)	Introduced separate/communal electorates for Muslims (see Part 8)
Government of India Act, 1919 (Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms)	Introduced dyarchy in the provinces (subjects split into "transferred" and "reserved") and bicameralism at the centre (see Part 8)
Government of India Act, 1935	Proposed an All-India Federation (never fully implemented) and gave provinces autonomy; became the structural template later used for the Constitution of India

MEMORY TRICK

"Really Prudent Committees Can't Control Corrupt Ministers' Illegal Games" — Regulating(1773) → Pitt's(1784) → Charter 1793/1813/1833/1853 → Crown takeover(1858) → Councils 1861/1892/1909 → Montford(1919) → India Act(1935) → Government.

PYQ: Which Act ended the East India Company's trade monopoly except in tea and China trade? **Ans: Charter Act, 1813**

PYQ: Who was the first Governor-General of India (as opposed to of Bengal)? **Ans: Lord William Bentinck, under the Charter Act of 1833**

PYQ: Under which Act did the "Governor-General" become the "Viceroy"? **Ans: Government of India Act, 1858; first Viceroy: Lord Canning**

2 Socio-Religious Reform Movements

A near-guaranteed SSC topic, almost always tested as "match the organisation with its founder/year". Learn this master table cold.

Organisation	Founder	Year	Place	Focus
Atmiya Sabha	Raja Ram Mohan Roy	1814	Calcutta	Precursor to Brahmo Samaj; anti-idolatry discussion circle
Brahmo Sabha / Brahmo Samaj	Raja Ram Mohan Roy	1828	Calcutta	Monotheism; opposed Sati, child marriage, polygamy; promoted women's education
Young Bengal Movement	Henry Louis Vivian Derozio	1820s	Calcutta	Radical rationalist student movement at Hindu College
Tattvabodhini Sabha	Debendranath Tagore	1839	Calcutta	Revitalised the Brahmo Samaj after Ram Mohan Roy's death
Paramhans Mandali	—	1840	Bombay	Worked for the abolition of caste restrictions
Prarthana Samaj	Dr. Atmaram Pandurang	1867	Bombay	Rational worship, social reform (key associates: M.G. Ranade, R.G. Bhandarkar)
Arya Samaj	Swami Dayanand Saraswati	1875	Bombay	"Back to the Vedas"; opposed idolatry and caste rigidity; ran the Shuddhi (reconversion) movement; wrote <i>Satyarth Prakash</i>
Theosophical Society	Madame Blavatsky & Col. Olcott	1875	New York (HQ later at Adyar, Madras)	Studied and promoted ancient Hindu/Buddhist philosophy
Satyashodhak Samaj	Jyotiba Phule	1873	Pune/Maharashtra	Anti-caste movement; rights for peasants and lower castes; Savitribai Phule was a key co-worker
Aligarh Movement / M.A.O. College	Sir Syed Ahmed Khan	1875	Aligarh	Modern, scientific education for Muslims; founded the Scientific Society (1862) and journal <i>Tahzib-ul-Akhlaq</i> (1871)
Ramakrishna Mission	Swami Vivekananda	1897	Belur (near Calcutta)	Service to humanity and spiritual unity; Belur Math is its headquarters
Deoband Movement	Muhammad Qasim Nanautavi & Rashid Ahmad Gangohi	1866	Deoband, UP	Revivalist Islamic seminary (Darul Uloom Deoband)
Ahmadiyya Movement	Mirza Ghulam Ahmad	1889	Qadian, Punjab	Modernist Islamic sect; renounced the idea of jihad as holy war
Faraizi Movement	Haji Shariatullah	1820s	Bengal	Islamic reform among Bengal's peasantry
Self-Respect Movement	E.V. Ramasamy (Periyar)	1925	Tamil Nadu	Anti-caste, anti-Brahmin social equality movement
SNDP Yogam	Sri Narayana Guru	1903	Kerala	"One caste, one religion, one God for humankind"; social reform among marginalised communities
Bahishkrit Hitakarini Sabha	B.R. Ambedkar	1924	Bombay	Promoted education and social upliftment of the depressed classes

Reformist vs Revivalist — a key SSC distinction: **Reformist** movements (Brahmo Samaj, Prarthana Samaj, Aligarh Movement) leaned on **reason and conscience**. **Revivalist** movements (Arya Samaj, Ramakrishna Mission, Deoband) leaned on returning to a supposedly "purer" past tradition to resist Western cultural influence.

PYQ: Which of the following believed the Vedas were infallible? **Ans: Arya Samaj**

PYQ: Where was the Bahishkrit Hitakarini Sabha established? **Ans: Bombay**

PYQ: Which movement organised an anti-caste movement in Maharashtra? **Ans: Satyashodhak Samaj**

3 The Economic Critique — Drain of Wealth Theory

Dadabhai Naoroji first raised the "drain of wealth" idea in an **1867** paper, *England's Debt to India*, and fully developed it in his landmark book *Poverty and Un-British Rule in India* (1901). His argument: **roughly a quarter of India's revenue** was being transferred to Britain every year with **no economic return** to India — through Home Charges, salaries and pensions of British officials, military expenditure, interest on India-funded debt, and profits repatriated by British firms.

- Other economists who developed this theory further: **R.C. Dutt** (author of *The Economic History of India*) and **M.G. Ranade**.
- Naoroji's work directly led to the creation of the **Royal Commission on Indian Expenditure (1896)**, on which he himself served.
- **De-industrialisation**: a linked concept — cheap machine-made British goods (recall Part 1/2) destroyed Indian handicrafts and textiles, while India was pushed into supplying raw materials and buying back finished British goods — a classic colonial trade pattern examiners like to test as "why India de-industrialised".

PYQ: Who propounded the "Drain of Wealth" theory? **Ans: Dadabhai Naoroji**

PYQ: In which book did Dadabhai Naoroji present the Drain of Wealth theory in full? **Ans: Poverty and Un-British Rule in India (1901)**

4 Press & Censorship Laws

Law	Year	Viceroy	Key point
Vernacular Press Act	1878	Lord Lytton	Curbed only Indian-language newspapers (English-language papers exempt); <i>Amrita Bazar Patrika</i> famously escaped it overnight by converting to an English paper; repealed by Lord Ripon in 1881/82
Arms Act	1878	Lord Lytton	Required Indians (but not British/Anglo-Indians) to obtain a licence to possess firearms; unlike the Press Act, this one was not repealed
Newspaper (Incitement to Offences) Act	1908	Lord Minto	Allowed confiscation of press property for material judged to incite violence — a direct response to revolutionary-nationalist writings (see Part 8)
Indian Press Act	1910	Lord Minto	Empowered local governments to demand security deposits from printers/publishers and forfeit them for "objectionable" material

First newspaper in India: *Bengal Gazette* (also called *Hicky's Bengal Gazette*), started by **James Augustus Hicky** in 1780 — openly critical of the East India Company, and shut down within about two years as a result.

PYQ: Who introduced the Vernacular Press Act, 1878? **Ans: Lord Lytton**

Newspapers & journals — quick match list

Paper/Journal	Founder/Editor
Comrade	Maulana Mohammad Ali
Al-Hilal	Maulana Abul Kalam Azad (recap, Part 8)

Paper/Journal	Founder/Editor
Commonweal & New India	Annie Besant (recap, Part 5)
Kesari (Marathi) / Mahratta (English)	Bal Gangadhar Tilak (recap, Part 5/8)
Udbodhan	Swami Vivekananda
Independent	Motilal Nehru
Tahzib-ul-Akhlaq	Sir Syed Ahmed Khan
Young India / Harijan	Mahatma Gandhi (recap, Part 7)
Nibandhmala	Vishnushastri Chiplunkar (1874, Marathi social-reform monthly)

5 Post-Independence — Integration of the Princely States (1947–1949) 🔥

At Independence, roughly **565 princely states** existed, covering about 40–48% of the subcontinent's territory. Each had to choose: join India, join Pakistan, or (in theory) remain independent. This process was led by **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel** (Deputy PM and Home Minister — the "**Iron Man of India**") with **V.P. Menon** (Secretary, Ministry of States) as his chief administrator.

- The legal tool used was the **Instrument of Accession** — states initially transferred only defence, external affairs, and communications to India.
- Patel's approach combined **diplomacy, persuasion, financial incentives (Privy Purses)**, and — only as a last resort — **military/direct intervention**.

State	Complication	Resolution
Junagadh	Muslim Nawab (Mahabat Khanji III) tried to accede to Pakistan despite a Hindu-majority population	India took administrative control (9 Nov 1947); a plebiscite in February 1948 showed over 99% in favour of India; merged into Saurashtra, later Gujarat
Hyderabad	Hindu-majority state, Muslim ruler (the Nizam, Osman Ali Khan) wanted independence; the Razakar militia (led by Kasim Rizvi) caused widespread violence	"Operation Polo" (police action), 13 September 1948 — Nizam's forces surrendered within about 4–5 days (by 17 September 1948); Nizam later made Rajpramukh (governor)
Jammu & Kashmir	Maharaja Hari Singh initially sought independence; Pakistan-backed tribal forces invaded in October 1947	Maharaja signed the Instrument of Accession on 26 October 1947 ; Indian troops airlifted to Srinagar; Sheikh Abdullah formed an interim government; special status later granted (1952 Delhi Agreement, then Article 370 — revoked in August 2019)
Manipur	Maharaja Bodhchandra Singh signed accession while retaining internal autonomy (recap, Part 8)	Instrument of Accession signed 11 August 1947

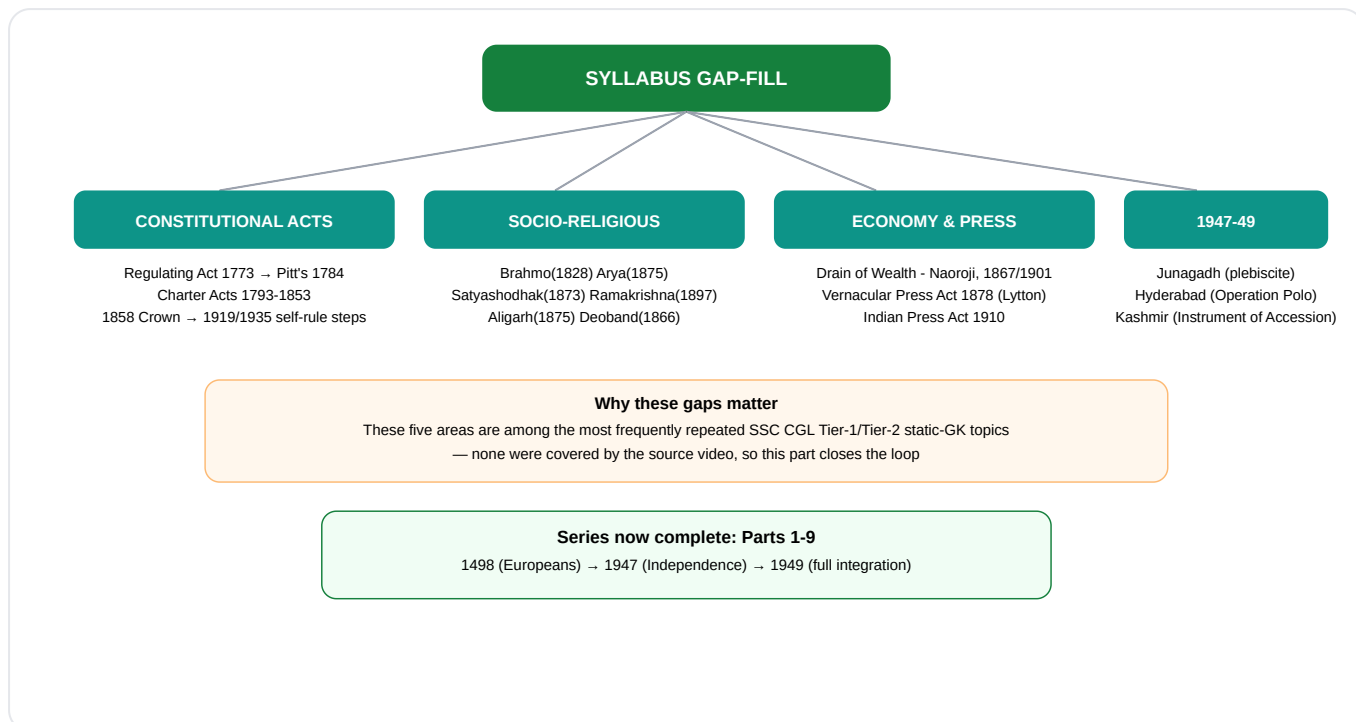
- PYQ:** What was the code name for the military action that integrated Hyderabad? **Ans: Operation Polo, September 1948**
- PYQ:** Who assisted Sardar Patel in the integration of princely states as Secretary of the Ministry of States? **Ans: V.P. Menon**
- PYQ:** What percentage of Junagadh's plebiscite (Feb 1948) favoured joining India? **Ans: Over 99%**

6 Master Reference Table

Superlative / Record	Answer
First Governor-General of Bengal	Warren Hastings (Regulating Act, 1773)
First Governor-General of India	Lord William Bentinck (Charter Act, 1833)
First Viceroy of India	Lord Canning (Government of India Act, 1858)
Founder of Brahmo Samaj	Raja Ram Mohan Roy, 1828
Founder of Arya Samaj	Swami Dayanand Saraswati, 1875
Founder of Ramakrishna Mission	Swami Vivekananda, 1897

Superlative / Record	Answer
Founder of Satyashodhak Samaj	Jyotiba Phule, 1873
Propounded Drain of Wealth theory	Dadabhai Naoroji, 1867/1901
Vernacular Press Act	1878, Lord Lytton; repealed 1881/82 by Lord Ripon
First Indian newspaper	Bengal Gazette (Hicky's), 1780
Led Operation Polo (Hyderabad)	September 1948
Architect of princely state integration	Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel & V.P. Menon
Kashmir's Instrument of Accession signed	26 October 1947

7 Mind Map — Syllabus Gap-Fill



8 30-Second Revision

Fact	Value
First Governor-General of India	William Bentinck, 1833
First Viceroy of India	Lord Canning, 1858
Brahmo Samaj / Arya Samaj founders	Ram Mohan Roy (1828) / Dayanand Saraswati (1875)
Drain of Wealth theory	Dadabhai Naoroji
Vernacular Press Act	1878, Lord Lytton
First Indian newspaper	Bengal Gazette, 1780
Operation Polo	Hyderabad, September 1948
Kashmir's accession	26 October 1947

9 Practice Questions (Modelled on Real SSC CGL PYQs)

1. Which Act first created the post of Governor-General of Bengal?

Ans: Regulating Act, 1773

2. Which Act established the Board of Control and the system of "dual government"?

Ans: Pitt's India Act, 1784

3. Which Charter Act ended the Company's monopoly on trade except tea and China trade?

Ans: Charter Act, 1813

4. Which Act made the Company a purely administrative body with no commercial function?

Ans: Charter Act, 1833

5. Which Act introduced open competition for the civil services?

Ans: Charter Act, 1853

6. Which Act transferred power from the Company to the British Crown?

Ans: Government of India Act, 1858

7. Raja Ram Mohan Roy founded which discussion group in 1814, before the Brahmo Samaj?

Ans: Atmiya Sabha

8. Who revitalised the Brahmo Samaj after Ram Mohan Roy's death, founding the Tattvabodhini Sabha?

Ans: Debendranath Tagore

9. Which samaj was founded by Dr. Atmaram Pandurang in Bombay in 1867?

Ans: Prarthana Samaj

10. What was Swami Dayanand Saraswati's slogan?

Ans: "Back to the Vedas"

11. What was the "Shuddhi" movement associated with?

Ans: Arya Samaj — reconversion of Hindus who had converted to Islam/Christianity

12. Who founded the Theosophical Society, and where?

Ans: Madame Blavatsky and Colonel Olcott, in New York, 1875

13. Which anti-caste organisation did Jyotiba Phule found in 1873?

Ans: Satyashodhak Samaj

14. Which college/movement did Sir Syed Ahmed Khan found at Aligarh?

Ans: M.A.O. College / the Aligarh Movement, 1875

15. Where is the headquarters of the Ramakrishna Mission?

Ans: Belur Math, near Kolkata

16. Which Islamic seminary/movement began at Deoband, UP, in 1866?

Ans: The Deoband Movement (Darul Uloom Deoband)

17. Who founded the Self-Respect Movement in Tamil Nadu?

Ans: E.V. Ramasamy (Periyar), 1925

18. What was Sri Narayana Guru's famous slogan?

Ans: "One Caste, One Religion, One God for humankind"

19. Who propounded the "Drain of Wealth" theory, and in which book?

Ans: Dadabhai Naoroji; "Poverty and Un-British Rule in India"

20. Approximately what share of India's revenue did Naoroji claim was "drained" to Britain annually?

Ans: About one-fourth (25%)

21. Which commission was set up as a direct result of Naoroji's drain theory?

Ans: The Royal Commission on Indian Expenditure, 1896

22. Who introduced the Vernacular Press Act, 1878, and who repealed it?

Ans: Introduced by Lord Lytton; repealed by Lord Ripon (1881/82)

23. Which newspaper famously escaped the Vernacular Press Act by converting to English overnight?

Ans: Amrita Bazar Patrika

24. What was India's first newspaper, and who founded it?

Ans: Bengal Gazette (Hicky's Bengal Gazette), by James Augustus Hicky, 1780

25. Which Act (1910) empowered local governments to demand security deposits from printers/publishers?

Ans: The Indian Press Act, 1910

26. Who led the diplomatic integration of India's princely states after Independence?

Ans: Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, with V.P. Menon

27. What was the military operation that integrated Hyderabad called?

Ans: Operation Polo, September 1948

28. How was Junagadh finally integrated into India?

Ans: Through a plebiscite in February 1948 (over 99% in favour of India)

29. On what date did Maharaja Hari Singh sign Kashmir's Instrument of Accession?

Ans: 26 October 1947

30. What financial incentive did Patel offer princely rulers to encourage accession?

Ans: Privy Purses (abolished later, in 1971)

10 Bonus — A Few More High-Yield Static Facts

- **Ilbert Bill Controversy (1883):** Proposed allowing Indian judges to try British subjects; provoked fierce British settler opposition and was diluted — a good precursor fact to why Indians felt the need for an organised political voice (leading to the INC in 1885, Part 5).
- **Age of Consent Act, 1891:** Raised the age of consent for marriage to 12 — passed after public debate stirred by social reformers, and often paired in MCQs with the Sarda Act, 1929 (raised marriage age further, to 14 for girls/18 for boys).
- **Hunter Education Commission, 1882:** Reviewed the state of Indian education post-Wood's Despatch (1854) — a good link back to the "education acts" thread that includes Macaulay's 1835 English Education Act (Part 2).
- **Government of India Act, 1935's lasting legacy:** Roughly 250 of its provisions were directly borrowed into the Constitution of India (1950) — the single largest "ancestor" document to India's current constitution.